



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Redeemer Classical Christian School
School Website: <https://rccs.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Redeemer Classical Christian School Maryland (MD 21087) demonstrates strong alignment with classical education, particularly in its explicit commitment to the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books-based learning, formation of character, and a Christian worldview that integrates faith with reason. Public-facing materials emphasize truth, goodness, and beauty as transcendent aims; formation of virtue and wisdom as primary goals; a curriculum centered on liberal arts and great works; pedagogy that blends memory work, recitation, singing, and formal Socratic-style discussion; a living, engaged faculty; and an active partnership with families and a hospitable, open-doors community. Taken together, these elements position Redeemer as CLASSICAL across the six categories of analysis.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- **Evidence:** The school grounds its entire program in God and Christian faith; the curriculum and daily practice are framed by a Christian worldview, Scripture, and theology as an overarching influence on all disciplines. Public materials include explicit statements that God exists, that all learning is rooted in Him, and that truth, goodness, and beauty are real and knowable through a Christian lens. For example, the school states that "All our learning is rooted in the truth that God exists, that we are made in His image, and that He is reconciling the world to Himself through His Son, Jesus Christ," and that the study of humanities centers on Truth, Beauty, and Goodness within a Biblical framework. It also references Biblical standards of conduct and the belief that Jesus Christ is Lord of all.
- **Positive/Negative keyword analysis:** Positive keywords present include truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, faith, theology, God, sacred, worship/liturgy (implied through communal faith life), and Christian worldview. Negative keywords (e.g., secularism, relativism) are not evident in the public materials. Overall: high density of positive indicators; no clear negative signals in this dimension.
- **Why this rating:** The school directly anchors its mission and pedagogy in transcendent Christian truths and theological commitments, with explicit emphasis on the ultimate realities of truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable, and with worship/communal-faith life integrated into school life.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- **Evidence:** Core statements emphasize formation of virtue and wisdom, not mere information or job prep. The school describes education as transformation of the whole person, the cultivation of wisdom and virtue, and the formation of students into virtuous human beings. The values of Wisdom, Virtue, and Faith explicitly frame the purpose, with education described as formation rather than information.
- **Positive/Negative keyword analysis:** Positive keywords include formation, virtuous life, human flourishing, wisdom, virtue, telos, contemplation, and moral imagination. Negative signals (such as "career-readiness" or "21st-century skills" as primary goals) are not present in the public messaging. Overall: predominantly positive indicators toward a classical telos.

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- Why this rating: The school foregrounds formation, virtue, wisdom, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as the ultimate aims of education, consistent with classical paideia rather than merely preparing students for work.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: The curriculum is explicitly framed around the liberal arts, with Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric (the Trivium) as central stages. There is a stated emphasis on “great books” and a canon-based Great Conversation, including the study of Latin and a focus on readings across geometry, poetry, biology, and humanities within a Christian framework. The presence of a thesis project in the senior year illustrates a culmination in rhetorical and intellectual mastery.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation, Latin, history/Western civilization, wonder, and integration of faith with learning. Negative keywords (e.g., a purely project-based, social-studies-centered or STEM-first approach) are not emphasized in the public content. Overall: strong alignment with the classical curriculum model.
- Why this rating: Redeemer centers on the Trivium, the Great Books canon, Latin study, and a historically grounded, integrated curriculum that seeks to cultivate wonder and humanistic understanding.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Pedagogical practice is described as singing/recitation/memory work in the lower grades, with a shift to Socratic-style discussion, seminar-style inquiry, and rhetoric in the upper grades. The public materials emphasize restfulness and contemplative learning as part of an education that balances memory with dialogue and argumentation. The senior level explicitly emphasizes persuasive communication and rhetorical skill, with opportunities for oration and public speaking.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include scholé/restful learning, contemplation, memory work, narration/recitation, singing/chanting, Socratic dialogue/seminars, and rhetoric. The public-facing content shows these modes (particularly singing/recitation and Socratic-like discussion later). Negative signals anticipated by classical lexicon (e.g., exclusive project-based learning, over-emphasis on non-classical methods) are not dominant in the school’s messaging; rather, the school emphasizes a classical pedagogy. Overall: CLASSICAL, with clear evidence of both memory-based early education and Socratic/rhetoric-based upper-level teaching.
- Why this rating: The combination of memory/recitation/chanting in lower grades and Socratic/seminar/rhetoric in upper grades aligns with the classical pedagogy framework, including the Scholé-like aspects and the development of argumentative skills and public speaking.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: The school highlights small class sizes, teachers who know their students, and a mission centered on virtuous, well-prepared teachers who model character. The “Who We Are” and “Academics” pages reference faculty as central to the living curriculum, with a signal of ongoing faculty engagement in classical pedagogy and mentorship. The public materials also mention a “portrait of a teacher” and “faculty who are living curriculum” language consistent with classical education norms.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include masterful/virtuous teachers, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty as mentors, and small-class effects. Negative signals are not evident in the messaging; there is a clear emphasis on faculty as core to the school’s mission. Overall: CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating: Redeemer frames faculty as the central, virtuous exemplars who carry and model the curriculum, consistent with classical education’s emphasis on exemplary teachers and mentorship.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: The school foregrounds partnership with families and describes parent involvement as a co-educator, with explicit mentions of parent education events, book studies, and a welcoming cam-

pus for visits. The presence of a robust Parent Engagement structure (FORTIS, Parent Education Events, and a Getting Involved guide) signals active parental partnership and ongoing formation of the broader educational community. Public content indicates openness to visitors and a culture of parental involvement.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, home-school collaboration, parent involvement, and community engagement. These align with the Strong Classical Parents & Community signals. No explicit negative signals are evident in the public materials. Overall: CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating: Redeemer presents parents as co-educators and actively seeks family involvement and education, aligning with the classical model's emphasis on formation through a shared home-school culture.

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

Overall, Redeemer Classical Christian School Maryland (MD 21087) presents a coherent classical education model across all six categories. The six-category rubric yields CLASSICAL in every domain, with strong textual evidence across the website demonstrating a Trivium-based curriculum, Great Books emphasis, formation-focused aims, a pedagogical blend of memory, recitation, Socratic discussion, and rhetoric, a living/faculty-centered curriculum, and a proactive, family-partnered community.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable in this case, as all six categories are rated CLASSICAL. If one sought to enhance alignment further, the school could consider explicitly articulating liturgical practices and a formal liturgical calendar on the public site (to align with the "Liturgical and Communal Practices" criterion more openly) or expanding direct quotes from faculty and governance that frame the "living curriculum" in more explicit, measurable terms. However, given the current content, no major needle-moving changes are required.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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